LESSON PLAN · SCRATCH JUNIOR (K–2) BEGINNER: LITTLE CODERS

# Lesson 4: Ready, Set, Green Flag!

Module 2 | 30 minutes | Events (starting a program) | KG–Grade 2 · ages 5–7

**Objective:** Start a script with the green flag block, and explain that a script needs a start block to run.

**Success criteria**

- I can start a script with the green flag.
- I know start blocks go first.
- I can make two characters start together.

## Key vocabulary

- **start block**: A block that makes a script begin.
- **green flag**: The button that starts the program.
- **script**: A row of blocks.

## You will need

- Projector with Kitabash (lesson video, Code Lab)
- Devices: 1 per learner or pair
- Printed worksheet (optional)

## Timed lesson plan (30 min)

| Time | Stage | What happens |
|---|---|---|
| 5 min | **Warm-up (unplugged)** | Red light, green light (5 min): children move only on “green flag!”. |
| 5 min | **Watch** | Play the lesson video with captions; pause at each heading and ask a question. |
| 8 min | **Build along** | Start with the flag: learners follow the steps. |
| 5 min | **Perform** | Start me up, Where does it go?, Hop to the pond, Build a script |
| 3 min | **Probe** | Green light! |
| 4 min | **Wrap-up** | Exit ticket: Point to the start block in your script. |

## Unplugged warm-up

Red light, green light (5 min): children move only on “green flag!”.

## Teaching the idea

Events: hat (start) blocks trigger scripts. In ScratchJr, the green-flag start block runs scripts when the flag is tapped; scripts without a trigger do not run.

**Analogy:** A race starts when the starter says “Go!”.

**Live demo:** Run a script with and without the green flag block; ask what changed.

## Questions to ask

| Ask | Listen for |
|---|---|
| What makes the script start? | The green flag. |
| Where does the flag block go? | First. |
| Can two characters start together? | Yes, each with a green flag. |

## Differentiation

**Support**
Pre-place the flag block; children add moves.

**Stretch**
Make two characters race when the flag is pressed.

## Common misconceptions

| Misconception | How to fix it |
|---|---|
| Tapping the flag runs any blocks | Only scripts that start with the flag block. |
| The flag goes at the end | It goes first. |

## Assessment

Use the Code Lab results (auto-checked), the quick checks and the Probe answers. Written answers arrive in your review queue.

**Exit ticket**
Point to the start block in your script.

**Homework**
Play “green flag go!” with your family: everyone moves when you wave a green paper flag.

## Answer key — Kitabash activities

### 1. Start me up (perform · block code)

**One solution:**

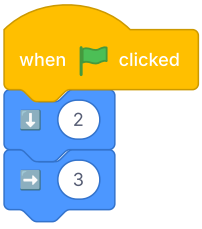



### 2. Where does it go? (perform · multiple choice)

**Answer:** At the start of the row

### 3. Hop to the pond (perform · block code)

**One solution:**




### 4. Build a script (perform · ordering)

**Order:** 🏁 Green flag → ➡️ Move right → ⬆️ Move up → 💬 Say “Hi!”

### 5. Green light! (probe · speaking)

## Answer key — worksheet

1. **Key words:** start block = A block that makes a script begin. · green flag = The button that starts the program. · script = A row of blocks.
2. **Where does it go?:** A. At the start of the row — Start blocks always go first.
3. **Build a script:** 1 🏁 Green flag · 2 ➡️ Move right · 3 ⬆️ Move up · 4 💬 Say “Hi!”
4. **Circle the start:** 🏁 green flag

Kitabash original curriculum. Scratch is a project of the Scratch Foundation in collaboration with the MIT Media Lab; this course is not affiliated with or endorsed by them.